A Guide for Learning and Playing Japanese Mahjong © 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) For full attributions, third-party content details, and licensing information, see the companion PDF: Back Matter

How to Calculate a Hand's Score

All players are responsible for ensuring that each winning hand is scored correctly and to the maximum points.

Each player has the primary responsibility for counting the han and minipoints (fu) of their own hand. They may ask for help if necessary, and other players are obliged to correct any mistakes made.

By using the Fu Calculation Chart and Scoring Tables provided in this packet, players may use the following steps to calculate a hand's score:

- Step 1: Count the number of han. Add together the han given by the yaku (at least one) and the han given by the dora, kandora, and uradora in the hand. Uradora are added only in case of a riichi hand. A tile indicated by multiple indicators counts as multiple dora. Each red five counts as one automatic dora. If a red five is indicated by a dora indicator, it counts for two han. If a red five is indicated by two dora indicators, it counts for three han, etc.

- Step 2: Calculate the number of minipoints (fu). Use the Fu Calculation Chart, adding the fu the hand scores from meeting the conditions of each row of the chart. Notes are provided below on the Fu Calculation Chart for guidance.
    - For hands with five or more han, the fu need not be calculated.

- Step 3: Find the value of the hand by using the Scoring Tables. Instructions for the tables are provided on the Scoring Tables sheet. Honba are added to the value shown in the table. For each honba on the table, 100 is added in case of a win by self-draw, or 300 in case of a win by discard.

- Step 4: In the case of multiple winners, the discarder settles the score with each winner individually. Each winner receives the value of their hand, including the value of counters in play.

Numerous scoring examples are given in this packet for study.

Fu (Minipoints) Calculation Chart

Base Fu		
Fixed	20	
+		
Sets	**Open**	**Closed**
Triplet, simples	2	4
Tripet, terminals/honors	4	8
Quad, simples	8	16
Quad, terminals/honors	16	32
+		
Pair		
Pair of dragons	2	
Pair of seat wind	2	
Pair of prevalent wind	2	
+		
Wait		
Pair wait	2	
Closed wait	2	
Edge wait	2	
+		
Win status		
Tsumo without pinfu	2	
Ron with a closed hand	10	

The above calculation result should be rounded up to the nearest multiple of 10 for the final count (e.g., if the result is 32, the final count would be 40 Fu).

*Special case 1: If a hand is won by Tsumo with a closed hand, and includes Pinfu, the result is fixed at **20 Fu**.
*Special case 2: If a hand is won with Seven Pairs, the result is fixed at **25 Fu**.
*Special case 3: If a hand is won with open calls, and the Fu is less than 30, the result is fixed at **30 Fu**.

Notes:
• If a discarded winning tile completes a triplet for a hand, that triplet is an *open triplet*.
• Double wind pair (seat + prevalent wind) counts as 2 Fu in most modern competitive rules, though some online games and casual rule sets may count it as 4 Fu.
• A pair wait is awarded when a hand has completed all four sets and wins on one specific tile to complete the final pair.
• A closed wait is awarded when a hand wins on the middle number tile of a sequence, such as when a hand has 46 and wins on 5, or has 12 and wins on 3.
• An edge wait is awarded when a hand has 12 and wins on a 3, or has 89 and wins on 7.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Scoring Tables

Dealer (East) Points Chart

Tsumo	1 han	2 han	3 han	4 han
20		700	1300	2600
25			1600	3200
30	500	1000	2000	3900
40	700	1300	2600	4000
50	800	1600	3200	4000
60	1000	2000	3900	4000
70	1200	2300	4000	4000
80	1300	2600	4000	4000
90	1500	2900	4000	4000
100	1600	3200	4000	4000

Ron	1 han	2 han	3 han	4 han
25		2400	4800	9600
30	1500	2900	5800	11600
40	2000	3900	7700	12000
50	2400	4800	9600	12000
60	2900	5800	11600	12000
70	3400	6800	12000	12000
80	3900	7700	12000	12000
90	4400	8700	12000	12000
100	4800	9600	12000	12000

▶ These tables give the amount opponents should pay for a dealer win. For the two tables above, use the column that gives the Han value of the hand and the row that gives the Fu value of the hand. For the table for limit hands, just use the column that gives the Han value of the hand.
▶ In the case of winning by self-draw (Tsumo), each opponent pays the dealer the amount shown. In the case of winning on a discard (Ron), the discarder pays for the full amount shown.

Limit hand	Han	Tsumo	Ron
Mangan	5	4000	12000
Haneman	6 - 7	6000	18000
Baiman	8 - 10	8000	24000
Sanbaiman	11-12	12000	36000
Yakuman	13+	16000	48000

Non-Dealer Points Chart

Tsumo	1 han	2 han	3 han	4 han
20		400 700	700 1300	1300 2600
25			800 1600	1600 3200
30	300 500	500 1000	1000 2000	2000 3900
40	400 700	700 1300	1300 2600	2000 4000
50	400 800	800 1600	1600 3200	2000 4000
60	500 1000	1000 2000	2000 3900	2000 4000
70	600 1200	1200 2300	2000 4000	2000 4000
80	700 1300	1300 2600	2000 4000	2000 4000
90	800 1500	1500 2900	2000 4000	2000 4000
100	800 1600	1600 3200	2000 4000	2000 4000

Ron	1 han	2 han	3 han	4 han
25		1600	3200	6400
30	1000	2000	3900	7700
40	1300	2600	5200	8000
50	1600	3200	6400	8000
60	2000	3900	7700	8000
70	2300	4500	8000	8000
80	2600	5200	8000	8000
90	2900	5800	8000	8000
100	3200	6400	8000	8000

▶ These tables give the points opponents should pay for a non-dealer win. Using the same instructions as above, the only difference is that where applicable, the larger number is the payment from the dealer, and the other number is the payment from each of the two other opponents.

Limit hand	Han	Tsumo	Ron
Mangan	5	2000 4000	8000
Haneman	6 - 7	3000 6000	12000
Baiman	8 - 10	4000 8000	16000
Sanbaiman	11-12	6000 12000	24000
Yakuman	13+	8000 16000	32000

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Scoring Examples

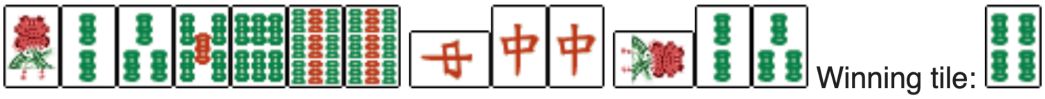
Scoring example 1: Mangan

The winning tile is 9-sou by self-draw. The hand is closed. The player has declared riichi. The hand scores 1 han for Riichi, 1 han for Fully Concealed Hand, 1 han for Pinfu and 2 han for Pure Straight (because the hand is closed). Total: 5 han. If there are no dora, kandora, or uradora, the hand value is 5 han. Since the hand value is 5 han or greater, the Fu value of the hand need not be calculated. This is the limit hand called mangan and it scores 4,000 from each if the winner is East—a total of 12,000 points. If the winner is not East, they receive 4,000 from East and 2,000 from each of the other opponents—a total of 8,000 points.

Scoring example 2: Haneman

The winning tile is 4-sou by self-draw in the set of uninterrupted turns immediately after the player has declared riichi. The hand scores 1 han for Riichi, 1 han for Ippatsu, 1 han for Fully Concealed Hand, 1 han for All Simples and 2 han for Seven Pairs. Total: 6 han. Since the hand value is 5 han or greater, the fu value of the hand need not be calculated. This is the limit hand called haneman, and it scores 6,000 from each if the winner is East—a total of 18,000 points. If the winner is not East, they receive 6,000 from East and 3,000 from each of the other opponents—a total of 12,000 points.

Scoring example 3: Non-Dealer Ron



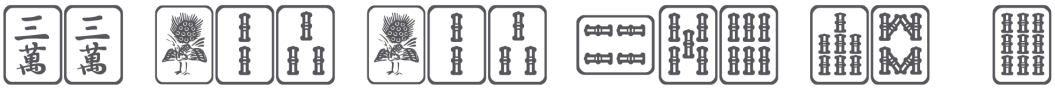
This hand has 2 han from Half Flush and 1 han from Red Dragon, for a total of 3 han. Since the hand has less than 5 han, the fu value of the hand needs to be calculated. The hand has 20 base fu, plus 4 fu from the open honor triplet. The 24 fu rounds up to 30. So this hand has 3 han 30 fu. The scoring table indicates the score is 3900, to be paid in full by the discarder.

Scoring example 4: Non-Dealer Tsumo

This hand has 1 han from Pure Double Sequence and 1 han from Fully Concealed Hand, for a total of 2 han. Since the hand has less than 5 han, the fu value of the hand needs to be calculated. This hand has 20 base fu, 32 fu from the closed 1-man quad, 8 fu from the closed 9-sou triplet, 2 fu from the pair of dragon tiles, and 2 fu from tsumo without pinfu. The summed fu is 64, which rounds up to 70. The hand has 2 han 70 fu, and the scoring table indicates the score is 1200/2300, meaning 2300 to be paid by the dealer and 1200 to be paid by each of the other opponents.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Scoring example 5: Dealer Ron

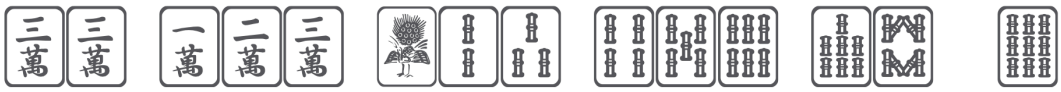


The winning tile is 9-sou by discard. The hand contains an open 456-sou sequence. 7-sou is dora. The hand scores 1 han for Pure Straight (because the hand is open) and 1 additional han for the dora tile. Total: 2 han. Minipoints: 20 base fu. Citing Special Case 3 from the Fu Calculation Chart, if a hand is won with open calls, and the Fu is less than 30, the result is fixed at 30 fu. The hand value is 2 han, 30 fu. Since the dealer won, it scores 2,900 from the discarder.

Scoring example 6: Dealer Tsumo

The winning tile is 4-sou by self-draw. The player has not declared riichi. The hand scores 2 han for Seven Pairs and 1 han for Tsumo. Citing Special Case 2 from the Fu Calculation Chart, if a hand is won with Seven Pairs, the result is fixed at 25 fu. The hand scores no further minipoints even though there is a pair of dragons and a pair wait, each of which would have added 2 fu. The hand value is 3 han, 25 fu, and it scores 1600 to be paid from each opponent.

Scoring example 7: To Be Mangan or Not To Be Mangan



The winning tile is 9-sou by discard. The hand is closed. The player has declared riichi. The hand scores 1 han for Riichi, 1 han for Pinfu and 2 han for Pure Straight (Note that even though it is a claimed tile that finishes the Pure Straight, it still scores 2 han because the hand is closed.) Total: 4 han. Minipoints: 20 base fu plus 10 for winning by ron with a closed hand. There are no further minipoints. If there are no dora, kandora, or uradora, the hand value is 4 han, 30 fu. The hand scores 11,600 from the discarder if the winner is East. If the winner is not East, the hand scores 7,700.

Note: If the rule variation kiriage mangan (mangan rounding) is used (see the Additional Notes on Scoring sheet in this packet), this hand's score would be rounded up to mangan. In this case, the hand would score 12,000 from the discarder if the winner is East. If the winner is not East, the hand would score 8,000.

Scoring example 8: Pinfu

The winning tile is 4-pin by self-draw. The hand is closed. The player has not declared riichi. The hand scores 1 han for Pinfu and 1 han for Fully Concealed Hand. Total: 2 han. Citing Special Case 1 from the Fu Calculation Chart, if a hand is won by Tsumo with a closed hand, and includes Pinfu, the result is fixed at 20 fu. The hand value is 2 han, 20 fu, and scores 700 to be paid by each opponent.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Scoring example 9: Pinfu Nomi

The winning tile is 2-pin by discard. The hand is closed. The player has not declared riichi. The hand scores 1 han for Pinfu. Total: 1 han. The hand has 20 base fu, plus 10 fu for winning by ron with a closed hand. The hand value is 1 han, 30 fu, and scores 1,500 as a dealer or 1,000 points as a non-dealer, to be paid by the discarder.

Scoring example 10: Not Quite Four

It is the South round and the player is West. The winning tile is 3-sou by discard. The hand is closed. The player has not declared riichi. The hand scores 2 han for Three Concealed Triplets and 1 han for Red Dragon. Total: 3 han. The hand has 20 base fu, 10 fu for winning by ron with a closed hand, 4 fu for the closed 7-man triplet, 4 fu for the closed 8-pin triplet, and 8 fu for the closed Red dragon triplet. We cite a note from the Fu Calculation Chart: if a discarded winning tile completes a triplet for a hand, that triplet is an open triplet. So the hand scores 2 fu for the open 3-sou triplet. The summed fu is 48, which rounds up to 50. The hand's value is 3 han, 50 fu, scoring 5,200 from the discarder.

Note: Had the player self-drawn 3-sou (or East wind), the hand would have scored the yakuman Four Concealed Triplets, earning 16,000 from the dealer and 8,000 from each of the two other opponents—a total of 32,000 points.

Scoring example 11: Just Enough Fu

The dealer won this hand in the East round, with players deciding to use the Recommended Ruleset for Casual Play at the end of the Additional Rules & Supplementary Material packet before the start of the game. The dealer declared riichi, drawing the winning tile within the first uninterrupted set of turns after the declaration. The hand scores 1 han from Riichi, 1 han from Ippatsu, and 1 han from Red Dragon. Total: 3 han. The hand has 20 base fu, 10 fu from winning by ron with a closed hand, 8 fu for the closed Red Dragon triplet and 8 fu for the closed 1-sou triplet. Using notes from the Fu Calculation Chart, we also see the hand has 4 fu from the double wind pair and 2 fu for completing an edge wait. The summed fu is 52, which rounds up to 60. The hand's value is 3 han, 60 fu, which scores 11,600 from the discarder.

Note: Had the players chosen the Recommended Ruleset for Competitive Play, the double wind pair would only count for 2 fu, so the hand's value would have been 3 han 50 fu instead. This would score slightly less: 9,600 points.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Scoring example 12: Yakuman—All Honors

The winning tile is South wind by self-draw. The hand contains only honor tiles: winds and dragons. Because every tile in the hand is an honor tile, the hand qualifies for All Honors (*Tsuuiisou*).

This hand does not use the normal han and fu calculation system. Instead, it is scored as a yakuman, a special limit hand.

If the player is East (the dealer), the hand scores 48,000 total points, paid as 16,000 from each opponent.

If the winner were not East, the hand would instead score 32,000 total points, with 16,000 paid by East and 8,000 paid by each of the other two opponents.

Yakuman hands represent the highest class of winning hands in Japanese mahjong and always score a fixed limit value regardless of fu or additional han.

Note that yakuman hands always score the fixed yakuman value regardless of fu or additional han. Even if a hand could reach 13 or more han through yaku and dora, the score is still treated as a yakuman.

Scoring example 13: Double Yakuman—True Nine Gates

The South player has won this hand in the East round, with players deciding to use the Recommended Ruleset for Casual Play at the end of the Additional Rules & Supplementary Material packet before the start of the game. The hand is closed, and the winning tile is 2-pin by discard.

The hand contains the tile pattern 1112345678999-pin, waiting on any pin tile to win. Because the hand could win on any tile from 1-pin through 9-pin, it qualifies for True Nine Gates (*Junsei Chuuren Poutou*), which is awarded when the winning tile completes a nine-sided wait in a Nine Gates hand.

Under the Casual Play ruleset, True Nine Gates counts as a double yakuman.

Since the winner is not the dealer, the hand scores 64,000 total points, to be paid in full by the discarder.

Note: Had the players chosen the Recommended Ruleset for Competitive Play, the double yakuman would only count as a single yakuman, since double yakuman are not used in that ruleset. The hand would therefore score 32,000 points.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Additional Notes on Scoring

Note 1: On Multiple Configurations of a Hand

If a winning hand can be interpreted in multiple ways, the highest-scoring possibility is always chosen. This rule is why Twice Pure Double Sequence is always scored over Seven Pairs (except in rare cases when a hand's han value is already over 13 and it does not matter which is scored).

Note 2: A Dealer's Advantage

East receives 1.5x points for a win but also pays twice as much as the other players if an opponent declares a win by self-draw. This asymmetry ends up working out statistically to the dealer's favor. Over a large sample of games, each dealership earns a player about 500 extra points on average.

Note 3: Keep the Winning Tile Apart

Competitive rulesets often emphasize there must be no ambiguity on which tile is the winning tile, stating that the best practice is not to take the winning tile at all when declaring a win by discard. For a win by self-draw, it is advised to place the winning tile at a distance to the side of the hand (and not to mix it into the hand). This clarity in tile identity is particularly important not only because of the rule of furiten, but also because a hand must be properly awarded minipoints (fu) and yaku. The identity of the winning tile directly affects how a hand's fu is calculated — in particular, which type of wait was completed (e.g., edge, closed, or pair) — and whether a hand qualifies for Pinfu, which requires a two-sided wait and no extra fu. If a player were in furiten — because one of the potential winning tiles was already in their own discard history — they would be unable to win by claiming a discard at all (ron), even if another tile could complete their hand.

Note 4: Red Fives Usage

While red fives are common in casual and online riichi play, many formal tournament rulesets treat them as optional or exclude them entirely. Red fives originally became popular because they increase scoring opportunities and accelerate game pace, creating greater excitement and larger point swings. However, many competitive rulesets omit red fives to keep scoring more standardized, meaning they do not alter hand values beyond the core mechanics emphasized in formal play.

Note 5: Scoring Variations—*Kazoe Yakuman*, *Kiriage Mangan*, Double Yakuman, Yakuman Stacking

Different rulesets may score winning hands with dissimilar point values.

- Some rulesets cap a hand's scoring value below that of a yakuman. In this case, any hand that scores 11+ han would be scored as a sanbaiman, so even hands worth 13+ han don't count as yakuman. This prevents counted yakuman (*kazoe yakuman*) and ensures that only hands that fulfill a yakuman's requirements receive the limit hand yakuman and its associated point scoring value.
- *Kiriage mangan* (rounded mangan) is another scoring variation within rulesets. In this scoring adjustment, hands with values of 4 han 30 fu or 3 han 60 fu or greater are rounded up to score mangan.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

- In many competitive rulesets, hands that satisfy more than one yakuman pattern stack their values, so a double or triple yakuman is worth two or three times the base yakuman points. However, special single-wait or unique patterns (such as Thirteen-wait Thirteen Orphans, or Single-wait Four Concealed Triplets) usually do not automatically double. Other tournament and regional rulesets cap scoring at a single yakuman, meaning that even if a hand qualifies for multiple yakuman, only one is scored. Even online clients vary on their implementation of how yakuman may stack, and how special double yakuman cases such as Big Four Winds and True Nine Gates are handled, reflecting differences across all forms of play.

Note 6: The Mathematical Formula Behind a Hand's Score

Since the modern Riichi ruleset has existed in its widely-recognized form (from around the 1950–1960s) a hand's score (and thus all the entries of the scoring tables) have been fundamentally determined by a mathematical formula.

The procedure goes as follows. To determine a hand's score, first a quantity called the Basic Points of a hand are calculated by:

Basic Points = Fu * 2 ^ (2+Han)
where Fu is the Fu value of the hand and Han is the Han value of the hand

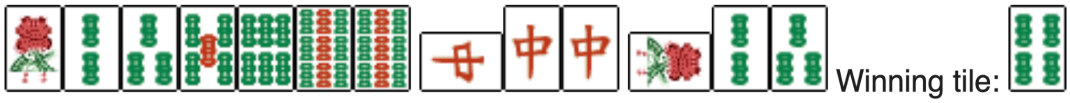
The Basic Points (BP) are then used to calculate the points received on a Non-Dealer Ron, Non-Dealer Tsumo, Dealer Ron, and Dealer Tsumo as shown below.

Table 1: Basic Points to Hand Score Conversion

Non-Dealer Ron	BP * 4 (rounded up to nearest 100)
Non-Dealer Tsumo	BP * 2 (dealer) BP * 1 (others) (rounded up to nearest 100)
Dealer Ron	BP * 6 (rounded up to nearest 100)
Dealer Tsumo	BP * 2 (each opponent) (rounded up to nearest 100)

This establishes a system where a Dealer Ron (6BP) nets 1.5x a Non-Dealer Ron (4BP) and a Dealer Tsumo (6BP total) nets 1.5x a Non-Dealer Tsumo (4 BP total), but where a Non-Dealer Tsumo forces the dealer to pay 2BP while the other players pay 1BP (so the dealer pays twice as much; compare with Note 2 above).

Example 1: Non-Dealer Ron

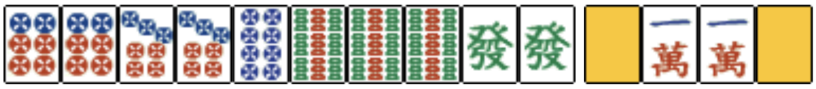


From Scoring Example 3, this hand was determined to have 3 han 30 fu, scoring 3900.

To show how that score was derived, we can use the formula BP = Fu * 2 ^ (2+Han), with Fu = 30 and Han = 3. The result is BP = 960. Because the win was by Non-Dealer Ron, the player who discarded the winning tile must pay 4 * BP (rounded up to nearest 100), or 960 x 4 = 3840, which rounded up gives 3900.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only

Example 2: Non-Dealer Tsumo

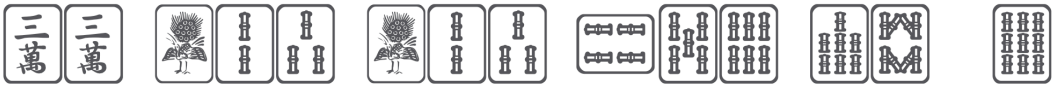


Winning tile:

From Scoring Example 4, this hand was evaluated to have 2 han 70 fu, scoring 1200 (others), 2300 (dealer).

Deriving the score from the mathematical formula, we first calculate the BP = Fu * 2 ^ (2+Han), with Fu = 70 and Han = 2. We get BP = 1120. Because the win was by Non-Dealer Tsumo, the two other non-dealers pay BP * 1 = 1120, and the dealer pays BP * 2 = 2240. Both of these numbers are rounded up, so the score is written as 1200/2300.

Example 3: Dealer Ron



From Scoring Example 5, this hand was determined to have 2 han, 30 fu, scoring 2,900.

To derive the score, we use the formula BP = Fu * 2 ^ (2+Han), with Fu = 30 and Han = 2. The result is BP = 480. Because the win was by Dealer Ron, the player who discarded the winning tile must pay 6 * BP (rounded up to nearest 100), or 480 x 6 = 2880, which rounded up gives 2,900.

Example 4: Dealer Tsumo

From Scoring Example 6, this hand was evaluated to have 3 han, 25 fu, scoring 1600 to be paid from each opponent.

To determine the score by hand, the formula BP = Fu * 2 ^ (2+Han), with Fu = 25 and Han = 3, gives BP = 800. Because the win was by Dealer Tsumo, the three other opponents each must pay 2 * BP (rounded up to nearest 100), or 800 x 2 = 1600.

It is important to note that when a hand has five han or more, the standard exponential formula Basic Points = Fu * 2 ^ (2+Han) and the corresponding Table 1 above are no longer used to determine a hand's scoring value. Instead, fixed scoring thresholds are employed. Once a hand hits five han, its value is taken directly from these predefined limits (mangan, haneman, baiman, sanbaiman, etc.), which are stepped values rather than values that grow exponentially with han. This system prevents extremely high scores from the exponential formula alone and effectively caps the hand value at set milestones as han increases. The fu count also becomes irrelevant once the hand is at a limit level; only the han total determines which limit applies.

© 2026 Christopher Yee (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0) Educational Use Only